



PHOTOS BY **RAJNEESH LONDHE**

Q: Coromandel International is today a ₹25,000-crore company. One of the things that worked out for it was the backward integration strategy. Tell us more about the success story.

A: We have done a lot of work at Coromandel over the last few years. One of them is backward integration, and to us, it came down to the value that already existed and needed to be captured. We moved with more focus and bought a mine in Senegal, which makes most of our rock phosphate, a key raw material for phosphoric acid.

The market always existed, and it was about doing something new. We also make sulphuric acid now, and that's a big change from being one of the largest importers.

Q: India is a fertiliser-deficient country, and we are close to the next sowing season. How do you view this challenge (shortages due to the war in West Asia) in terms of sowing being delayed or agricultural output falling?

A: I don't think there will be an issue during the first quarter. On the availability front, I think if this eases out, there should not be any problem.

The government has been saying the same thing. Most of the companies are covered for that period, and so are we. The other part relates to urea, and we imported that in a big way during the last quarter of the last calendar year.

Q: You have the advantage of scale and size, unlike some of the smaller companies. At an